TOP 10 COLLEGES WITH THE LOWEST FEES

RANK	COLLEGE	CITY	COURSE FEE* (ENTIRE DURATION) (₹)
1	RANI ANNA GOVERNMENT COLLEGE FOR WOMEN	Tirunelveli, TN	1,398
2	VELLALAR COLLEGE FOR WOMEN (AUTONOMOUS)	Erode	3,038
3	SONOPANT DANDEKAR SHIKSHAN MANDALI'S S.D. ARTS, V.S. APTE COMMERCE, M.H. MEHTA SCIENCE COLLEGE	Palghar	3,725
4	SRI G.V.G. VISALAKSHI COLLEGE FOR WOMEN (AUTONOMOUS)	Udumalpet, TN	4,245
5	V.O. CHIDAMBARAM COLLEGE	Thoothukkudi, TN	4,389
6	APC MAHALAXMI COLLEGE FOR WOMEN	Thoothukudi, TN	4,389
7	ALL SAINTS' COLLEGE	Thiruvananthapuram	5,400
8	GOVERNMENT ARTS COLLEGE (AUTONOMOUS)	Salem, TN	5,695
9	WALCHAND COLLEGE OF ARTS & SCIENCE (AUTONOMOUS)	Solapur, Maharashtra	6,015
10	STELLA MARIS COLLEGE (AUTONOMOUS)	Chennai	6,350

*For the entire duration; Course fees = Tuition fee + other fees

gaging ways. "We tried to make online learning more interesting," says Srivastava. Some lectures proved so interesting that even students from outside the science department attended, as happened in a Physics course conducted in collaboration with IIT Bombay.

To encourage entrepreneurial spirits, Srivastava says the college has also been aiding students explore work outside the curriculum—from helping them participate in online conferences to incubating new business ideas under Hindu's Innovation and Startup Policy, which was brought online in 2021. Digital technologies have played a key role. "We might not have had as many offline events last year as before," says Srivastava, "but we made up for the lack by providing other sources of growth, possibilities and discovery."

The college's effort to set up digital communities seems to have paid off. "We realised they might not have as much to do in the evenings during lockdowns, and so we held many of the additional lectures at that time—they had company, albeit a digital one," adds Srivastava. This, the administration says, helped students and faculty stay connected through difficult times while also allowing them to continue developing their communication, critical analysis and academic and social skills. ■

TOP 10 EMERGING COLLEGES

Highest ranked colleges of those set up in or after 2000

RANK	COLLEGE	CITY
1	KRISTU JAYANTI COLLEGE	Bengaluru
2	MANIPAL SCHOOL OF LIFE SCIENCES	Manipal
3	SCHOOL OF SCIENCES, JAIN UNIVERSITY (DEEMED)	Bengaluru
4	LAKSHMIBAI COLLEGE#	New Delhi
5	ST WILFRED'S PG COLLEGE	Jaipur
6	RAMANUJAN COLLEGE	New Delhi
7	DR N.G.P. ARTS & SCIENCE COLLEGE	Coimbatore
8	VIVEKANANDA COLLEGE	Kolkata
9	ST JOSEPH'S DEGREE & PG COLLEGE	Hyderabad
10	SRI KRISHNA ARTS & SCIENCE COLLEGE (AUTONOMOUS)	Coimbatore

#Lakshmibai College is included in this list because its BSc programme began in 2013